The Vietnam Findex 2025 Dashboard

Connectivity and Financial Inclusion in the Digital Economy

Technique Application Report

Dataset:	Vietnam – The Global Findex Dataset 2025: Connectivity and Financial Inclusion in the Digital Economy
Course:	Data Visualization
Instructor:	PhD. Tran Viet Trung
Group:	Group 6
Authors:	Ngo Minh Quang (20235550), Le Nguyen Phuoc Thanh (20235561), Hoang Van Nhan (20235542), Dinh Quoc Bao (20235478), Nguyen Quang Huy (20235505)

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1 Dataset Overview

The Global Findex 2025 is an appropriate dataset for this report because it combines financial access, digital connectivity, payment behavior, saving, borrowing, and resilience indicators in one nationally comparable survey. That combination makes it possible to study financial inclusion as a progression from readiness and access to usage and outcomes rather than as a single account-ownership rate.

The dashboard analyzed in this report uses the Vietnam microdata collected through face-to-face interviews from June 23 to August 31, 2024. The sample covers 1,000 adults aged 15 years and older and applies survey weights so the reported percentages represent Vietnam's adult population. The survey has an approximate design effect of 1.33 and a margin of error of ± 3.6 percentage points.

The report uses the dataset to answer three linked questions:

Q1. Where are the main gaps in digital readiness and formal financial access across income, education, gender, and location?

Q2. When adults have accounts, do wages, transfers, sales, and merchant payments actually move through digital channels or revert to cash?

Q3. How do different inclusion patterns relate to saving, borrowing, and shock-coping strategies across socioeconomic groups?

2 Dashboard Overview

The Vietnam Financial Inclusion Dashboard 2025 is a policy-facing interactive workspace built from 1,000 weighted Global Findex records for Vietnam. It reorganizes the survey into a five-page analytical flow so readers can move from demographic context to digital readiness, account access, transaction behavior, and financial resilience.

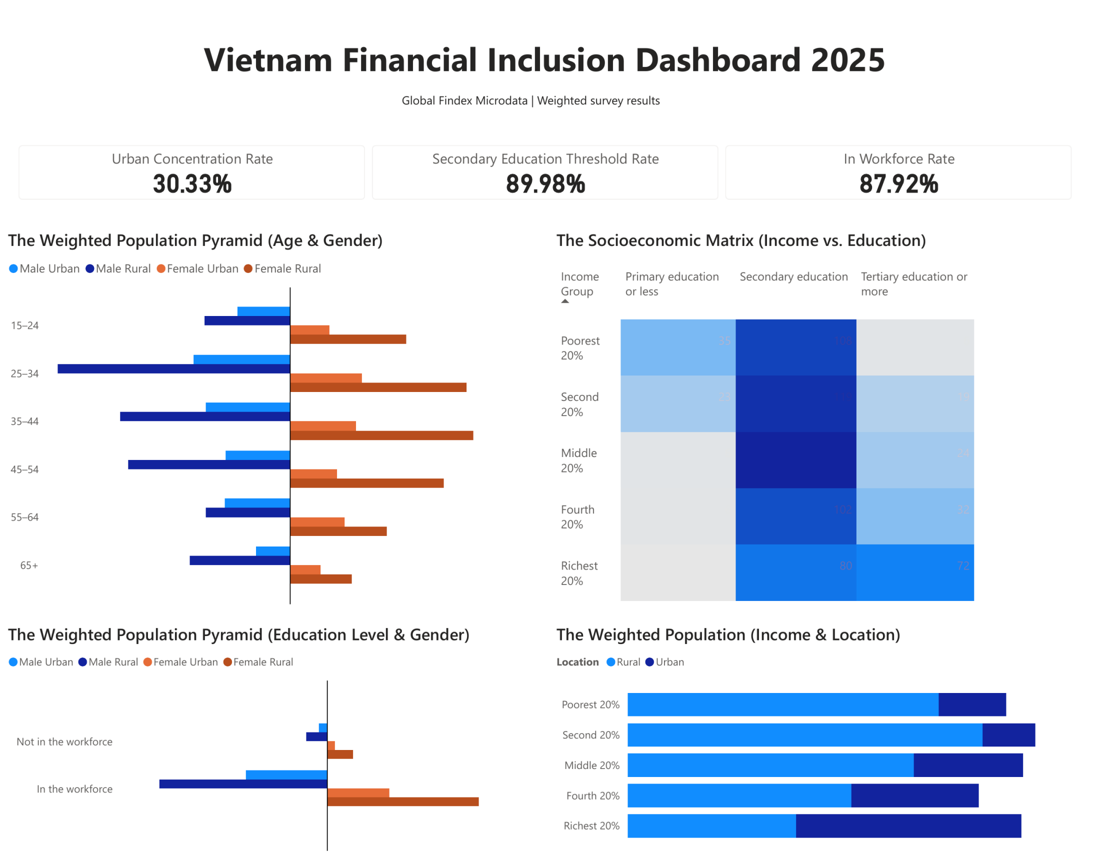


Figure 1: Overview of the Vietnam Financial Inclusion Dashboard.

The page sequence follows a macro-to-micro narrative: Page 1 establishes the demographic baseline, Page 2 checks connectivity and digital identity, Page 3 examines account ownership and exclusion barriers, Page 4 compares cash and digital transaction flows, and Page 5 links financial access with saving, borrowing, and coping capacity. As a result, the dashboard functions as a hybrid explanatory–exploratory system: it presents an authored policy story while still allowing subgroup investigation through interactive filters.

3 Chapter 1: Introduction to Data Visualization

3.1 Techniques / Principles Applied

- High-dimensional data reduction through visual summaries rather than row-by-row table inspection.
- Exploratory and explanatory visualization roles within the same dashboard.
- Policy-facing presentation that highlights actionable disparities instead of isolated statistics.

3.2 How Applied in the Dashboard

The raw dataset in `Findex_Microdata_2025_updateViet Nam.csv` contains 1,000 rows and 199 columns of individual survey information. In raw tabular form, the links between demographics, digital access, payment behavior, and resilience are difficult to see quickly. Visualization addresses that problem by turning survey weights into readable marks such as bar length, color intensity, and flow width, so the dashboard can show where exclusion and cash dependence are concentrated.

The dashboard also combines explanatory and exploratory roles. Its fixed five-page sequence guides the reader from population context to outcomes, while interactive filters on pages such as Account Ownership & Access Landscape and Financial Health & Resilience let analysts inspect specific subgroups. This combination is appropriate for a policy audience because it keeps the national story coherent while still supporting diagnosis.

3.3 Notes / Adjustments

Many visualization guidelines separate exploratory tools from guided presentations, but this dashboard places filters inside an authored narrative. That deviation is justified because financial inclusion questions are strongly intersectional, so readers often need to move from the national story to a specific subgroup without leaving the dashboard.

4 Chapter 2: Data Types, Marks, and Channels

4.1 Techniques / Principles Applied

- Classifying variables as nominal, ordinal, or quantitative before encoding them.
- Selecting marks that fit the analytical task: cells, bars, flows, and lines.
- Prioritizing precise channels such as aligned position and length for the most important quantitative comparisons.
- Using color, width, and enclosure as supporting channels rather than the primary source of exact comparison.

4.2 How Applied in the Dashboard

The dashboard aligns each page with the variable types and comparison task it needs to support. Table 1 summarizes the main encodings used across the five pages.

Chart/Page	Variables	Marks / channels	Why appropriate
Page 1 socioeconomic matrix	Income quintile, education, survey weight	Grid cells; row and column position; sequential color intensity	Two ordered categorical variables form a discrete matrix, while weighted population density is conveyed by ordered color.
Page 2 mobile ownership profile	Location, gender, income group, phone type, access rate	Bars; aligned length; grouped position; hue	Bar length supports accurate rate comparison across small multiples and hue separates phone types without changing the baseline.
Page 3 account composition flow	Location, account state, weighted volume	Sankey nodes and ribbons; horizontal position; ribbon width; color grouping	The chart emphasizes how groups move between account states, which is more important here than exact pairwise magnitude reading.
Page 4 inflow digitization	Inflow type, payment modality, percentage share	Segmented bars; aligned position; segment length; hue	A 100% stacked bar makes composition comparable across wages, agriculture, transfers, and other inflows.
Page 5 save vs. borrow trajectories	Income group, income runway, save rate, borrow rate	Lines; vertical position; color	The line overlays help readers track directional change across ordered categories.

Table 1: Main marks, channels, and encoding rationale used in the dashboard.

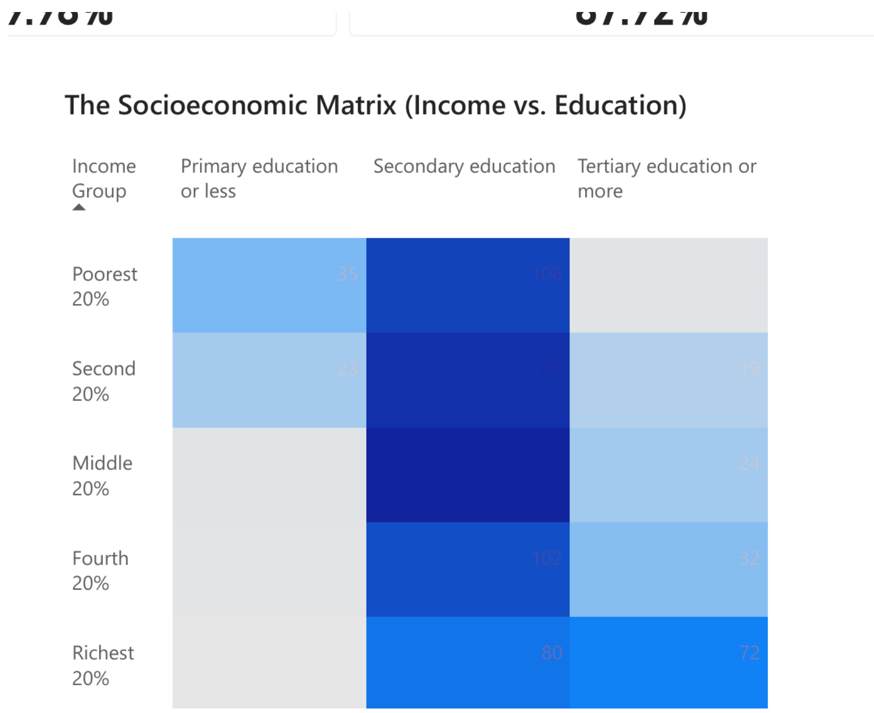


Figure 2: The socioeconomic matrix (income vs. education).

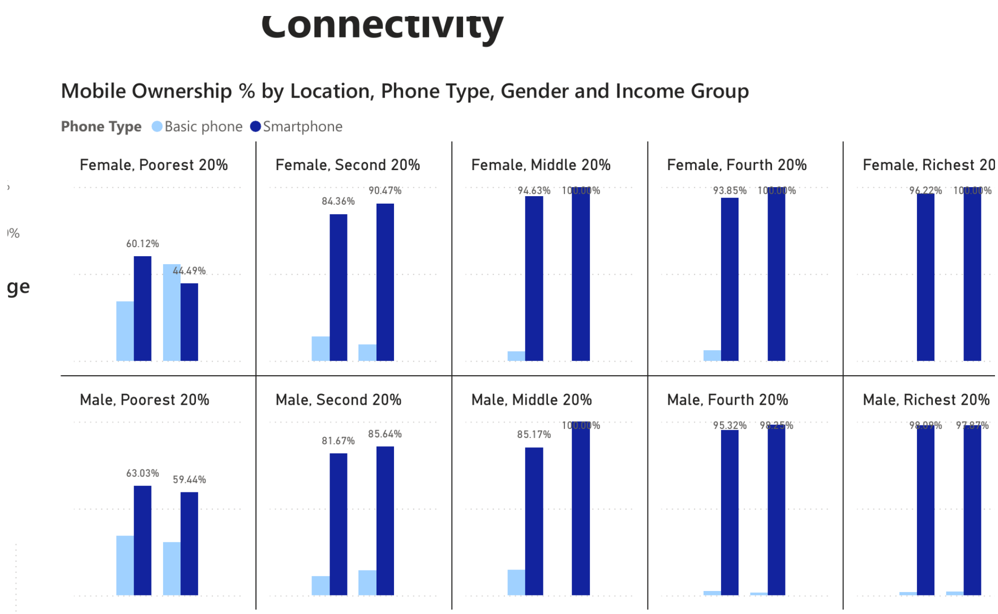


Figure 3: Mobile ownership rate by location, phone type, gender, and income group.

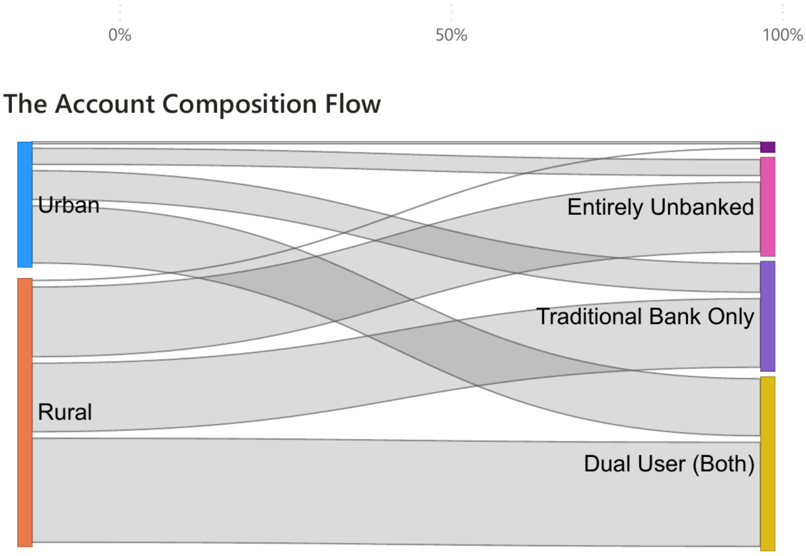


Figure 4: The account composition flow.

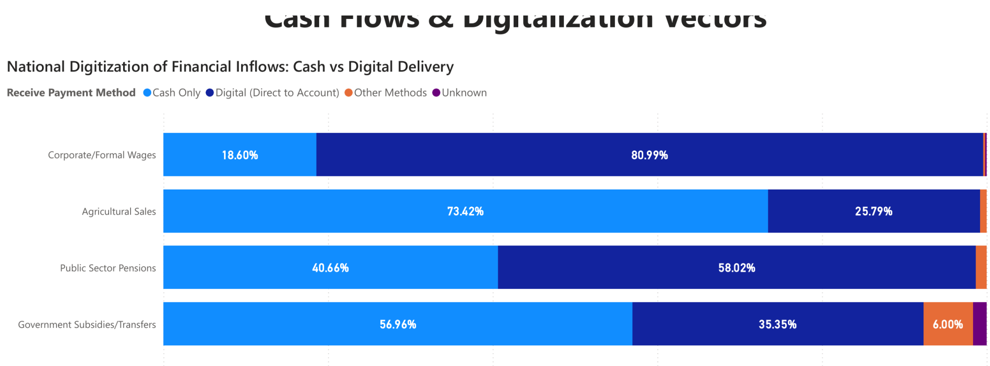
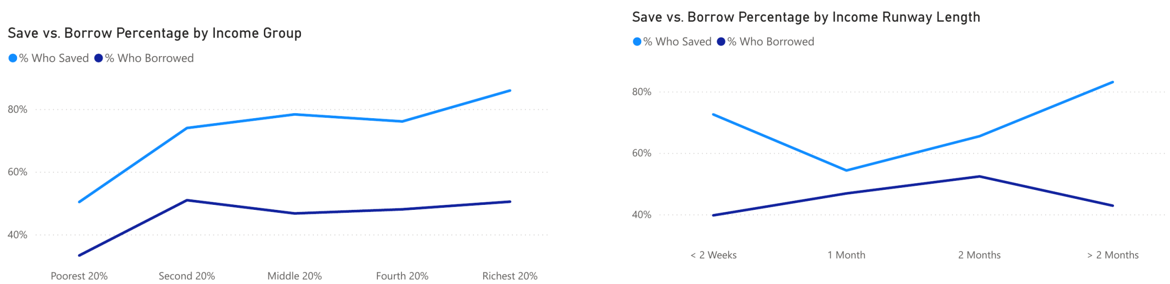


Figure 5: The national digitization of financial inflows: cash vs. digital delivery.



(a) By income group. (b) By income runway length.

Figure 6: Save vs. borrow percentage overlays.

These examples show the dashboard's encoding logic in practice: Page 1 uses a matrix to compare ordered categories, Page 2 uses small-multiples bars for precise subgroup comparisons, Page 3 uses a Sankey to emphasize structural flows, Page 4 uses segmented bars for composition, and Page 5 uses line overlays to highlight directional change across ordered groups.

4.3 Notes / Adjustments

The Sankey on Page 3 sacrifices some magnitude precision because ribbon width is less exact than bar length, but it better communicates movement between account states. On Page 5, the line overlays connect ordinal categories, so they imply continuity more than a strict categorical display would; the choice is kept to make change in save-versus-borrow behavior easier to track.

5 Chapter 3: Pre-Attentive Processing, Gestalt Principles, and Magnitude Estimation

5.1 Techniques / Principles Applied

- Pre-attentive processing through contrast, saturation, and enclosure.
- Gestalt grouping, especially proximity, similarity, and enclosure.
- Magnitude estimation that favors common baselines and linear length for important comparisons.

5.2 How Applied in the Dashboard

Pre-attentive pop-out is used to direct attention before detailed reading. On Page 1, Figure 2 uses darker blue cells to make high-density income–education intersections stand out quickly. On Page 2, the mobile ownership chart differentiates smartphone and basic phone rates with strong luminance contrast, so the penetration gap is visible without a full label-by-label scan.

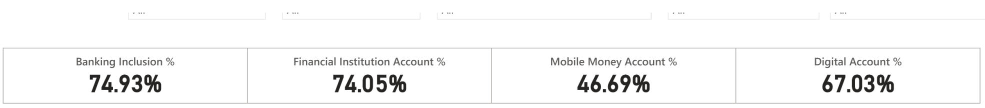


Figure 7: The Account Ownership & Access Landscape KPI cards.

Gestalt grouping is especially visible on Page 3. Figure 7 clusters the four KPI cards closely together, so proximity signals that they belong to the same summary layer. Enclosure appears in the filter strip, where the controls are visually separated from the charts they drive.

Figure 8: Filter controls on the Account Ownership & Access Landscape page.

Magnitude estimation is handled conservatively in the comparison-heavy charts. The Mobile Ownership Profile and the Exclusion Friction Log rely on bar length and aligned baselines because those channels are more accurate for comparing rates than area- or angle-based alternatives.

5.3 Notes / Adjustments

The Account Composition Flow in Figure 4 is less precise than a standard bar chart for direct magnitude comparison. The trade-off is accepted because the page needs to emphasize relationships between source groups and account states, not only isolated totals.

6 Chapter 4: Chart Types for Amounts, Distributions, Proportions, Relationships, and Trends

6.1 Techniques / Principles Applied

- Matching chart types to amounts, distributions, proportions, relationships, and trends.
- Preferring readable 2D Cartesian layouts for most dashboard comparisons.
- Recognizing when uncertainty is not displayed and what that implies for interpretation.

6.2 How Applied in the Dashboard

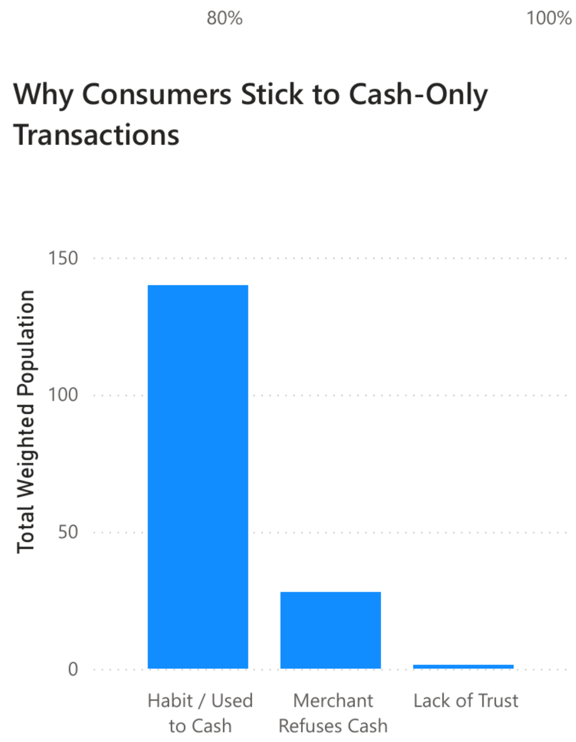


Figure 9: Why consumers stick to cash-only transactions.

Amounts. Figure 9 uses a standard bar chart to compare the weighted size of cash-only barriers. This is appropriate because the task is simple magnitude ranking, and bar length on a common baseline makes the differences easy to read.

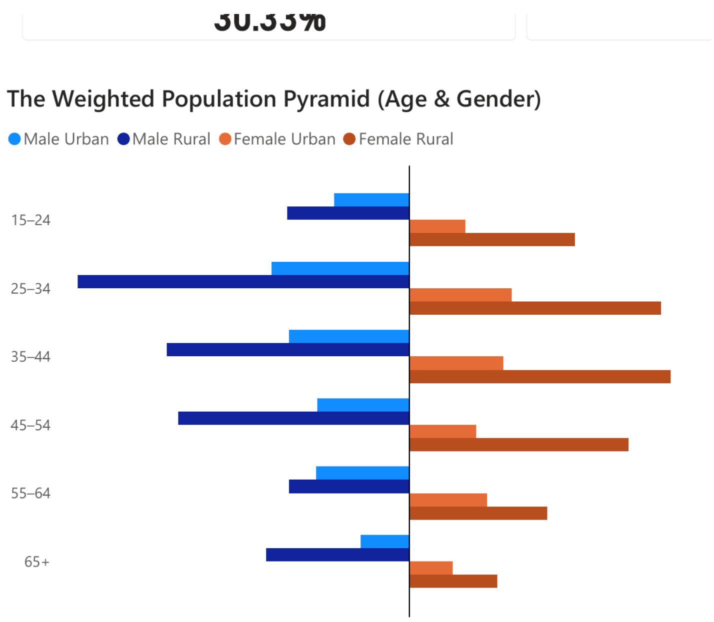


Figure 10: The weighted population pyramid by age and gender.

Distributions. Figure 10 and the socioeconomic matrix show how the population is distributed across age, gender, income, and education. These views are suitable because they reveal whether the sample is balanced or concentrated in specific groups before later policy comparisons begin.

Proportions. Figure 5 uses a 100% stacked bar layout to compare payment composition within each inflow type. This chart works well when the goal is to compare how cash, direct-to-account, and other channels share the same total.

Relationships. Figure 3 uses a small-multiples bar design to compare ownership patterns across location, gender, income, and phone type. The structure avoids overplotting while still showing how the variables relate to one another.

Trends. Figure 6 uses line overlays to show how saving and borrowing rates move across ordered income groups and income runway categories. The chart is effective for showing direction of change even though the categories are ordinal rather than continuous.

Across these examples, the dashboard relies mainly on a 2D Cartesian coordinate system because perpendicular axes support clearer comparison than radial or 3D alternatives for this type of policy dashboard. Statistical uncertainty is not explicitly visualized, so the charts are easy to read but can overstate precision, especially for filtered subgroup views.

6.3 Notes / Adjustments

The 100% stacked inflow chart emphasizes composition rather than exact comparison of every internal segment, so only the first segment in each row has a shared baseline. The save-versus-borrow lines also simplify ordinal data into continuous-looking trajectories, which improves readability but should be interpreted as directional rather than strictly continuous change.

7 Chapter 6: Visual Integrity (Ink, Overlap, Color, Layout, and Annotation)

7.1 Techniques / Principles Applied

- Proportional ink and true baselines for quantitative marks.
- Color choices that preserve contrast and basic accessibility.
- Overlap control, annotation, and data–context balance.

7.2 How Applied in the Dashboard

The dashboard maintains proportional ink by anchoring bar charts at true zero baselines and by keeping bar length or flow width tied to the underlying weighted values. This is visible in Figure 9 and in the previously introduced account-composition Sankey.

Color is used with restraint. Rural and urban comparisons rely on strong luminance contrast, Page 3 gender comparisons avoid low-contrast pairings, and the socioeconomic matrix keeps a single sequential palette so density is shown through intensity rather than extra hue variation.

Overlap is handled through panel separation, spacing, and concise annotation. Dense views are broken into smaller comparison units, while reference titles, legends, and benchmark markers provide context without covering the data.

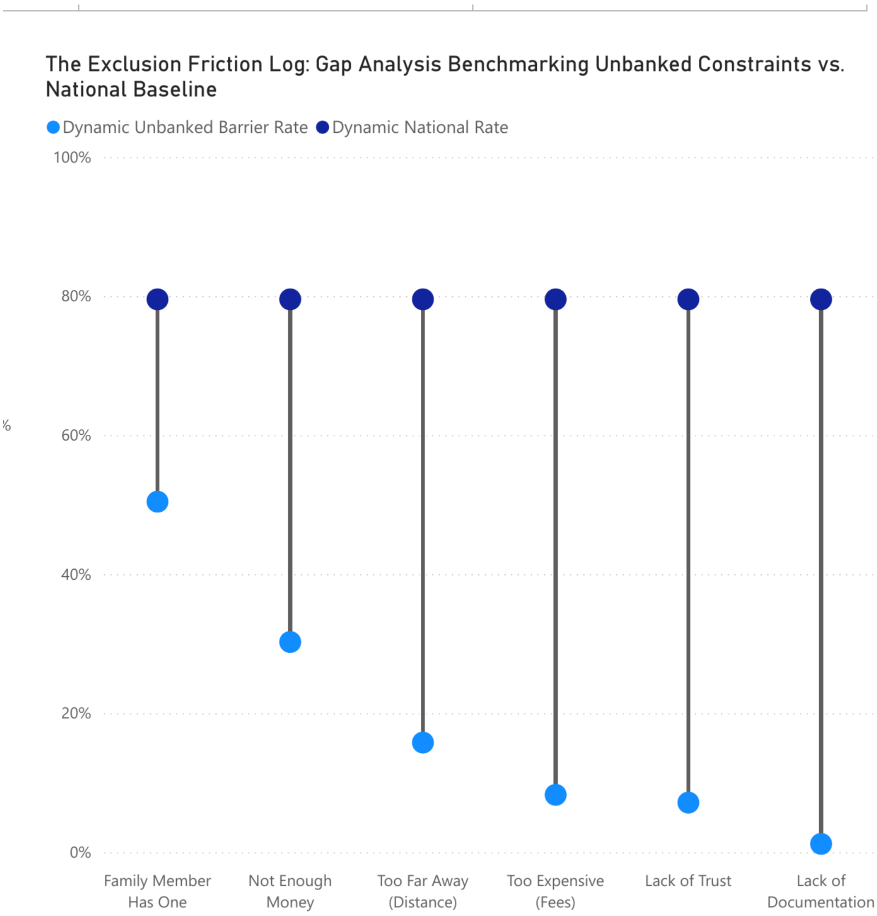


Figure 11: The Exclusion Friction Log: gap analysis benchmarking unbanked constraints vs. national baseline.

Figure 11 is a good example of data–context balance because the title, legend, and reference markers explain the benchmark logic without burying the chart under decorative elements.

7.3 Notes / Adjustments

The National Digitization of Financial Inflows chart in Figure 5 uses a 100% stacked format, so only the first segment in each row has a common baseline. That reduces precision for the inner segments, but the compromise is acceptable because the page is intended to show composition rather than exact segment-by-segment ranking.

8 Chapter 8: Interaction Techniques

8.1 Techniques / Principles Applied

- Overview first, then filter, then details-on-demand.
- Coordinated views that update several visuals from the same selection.
- Local page-level filters instead of one global interaction state.
- Power BI slicers and linked visuals as the main dashboard interaction tools.

8.2 How Applied in the Dashboard

The dashboard was built in Power BI and uses interaction mainly to extend a guided policy narrative into subgroup exploration. Users first see overview states on pages such as Account Ownership & Access Landscape and Financial Health & Resilience, then narrow the analysis through slicers, and finally use details-on-demand in the live dashboard to inspect exact values.

Figure 12: List of filters on the Account Ownership & Access Landscape page.

Figure 12 shows the main interaction design on Page 3: the page starts with a national overview, then lets users filter by urbanicity, income group, gender, education level, and workforce status. Within the live Power BI dashboard, those slicers coordinate the KPI cards, the Sankey diagram, and the exclusion-barrier chart so that all three reflect the same selected cohort.

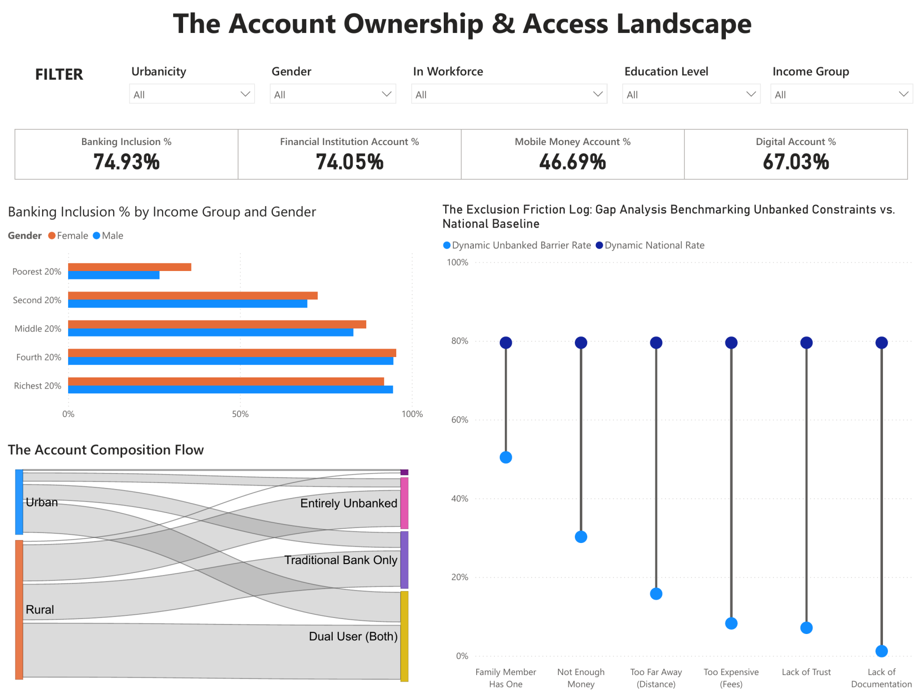


Figure 13: Default Account Ownership & Access Landscape state visible in the static PDF export.

The exported PDF confirms the placement of the filters and the default overview state. It also supports the claim that the dashboard uses local page-level interaction rather than one global control state shared across every page.

8.3 Notes / Adjustments

Because the available source is a static PDF export, this report cannot verify live hover tooltips, zoom behavior, animation, or the exact values produced by every filtered state. The chapter therefore describes the dashboard as designed for filtering, coordinated updates, and details-on-demand without claiming interactive evidence that is not directly visible in the exported file.

9 Chapter 9: Storytelling and Presentation Narrative

This section analyzes the Vietnam Financial Inclusion Dashboard 2025 as a data story rather than as a collection of independent Power BI visuals. Since the dataset and sampling background have already been discussed in the previous sections, this chapter focuses on how the dashboard transforms weighted survey evidence into a policy-oriented narrative about financial inclusion, digital readiness, account access, cash-flow usage, and financial resilience in Vietnam.

See Figure 1.

9.1 Dashboard Purpose and Storytelling Lens

Within the established data context, the dashboard functions as an institutional policy workspace. It does not only report whether adults have financial accounts; it also asks whether people are digitally ready, whether account ownership becomes actual financial usage, and whether financial participation is connected to saving, borrowing, and resilience outcomes. For this reason, the dashboard is best read as a sequential policy story rather than as a set of disconnected descriptive charts.

The organizing logic of the dashboard can be summarized as:

Context $\rightarrow$ Readiness $\rightarrow$ Access $\rightarrow$ Usage $\rightarrow$ Resilience

This structure is important because financial inclusion is not a single-step condition. Digital access does not always lead to active digital verification; account ownership does not always lead to digital cash-flow usage; and financial participation does not automatically guarantee resilience during financial shocks. The dashboard therefore guides the reader through a multi-stage diagnosis.

Context $\rightarrow$ Readiness $\rightarrow$ Access $\rightarrow$ Usage $\rightarrow$ Resilience

Figure 14: Narrative roadmap of the Vietnam Financial Inclusion Dashboard.

9.2 Narrative Walkthrough of the Dashboard

Before examining the formal storytelling dimensions, this walkthrough briefly shows how each dashboard page contributes to the overall story.

9.2.1 Page 1: Establishing the Socioeconomic Context

Page 1 acts as the exposition of the story by defining who is being analyzed before introducing financial indicators. The KPI cards show an Urban Concentration Rate of 30.33%, a Secondary Education Threshold Rate of 89.98%, and an In Workforce Rate of 87.92%. These values establish the demographic and socioeconomic baseline for the later financial inclusion analysis.

The strongest visual evidence on this page is the socioeconomic matrix. The Poorest 20% group has only 6 respondents with tertiary education or more, while the Richest

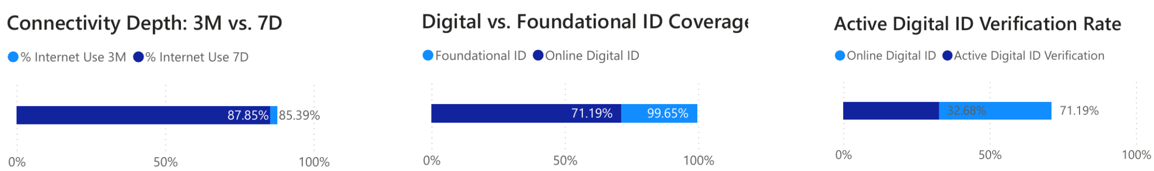
20% group has 72. This contrast frames financial inclusion as a socially structured issue shaped by income, education, location, and workforce participation.

See Figure 2.

9.2.2 Page 2: Diagnosing Digital Readiness

Page 2 shifts the story from population context to digital readiness. Internet Use in the last three months is 87.85%, and Internet Use in the last seven days is 85.39%, suggesting that internet access is frequent rather than occasional. However, the central insight is the gap between digital access and digital activation: Foundational ID coverage reaches 99.65%, Online Digital ID reaches 71.19%, but Active Digital ID Verification is only 32.68%.

This page therefore shows that digital infrastructure alone is not enough. Although many adults are connected and identifiable, far fewer actively use digital verification. This gap becomes an important bridge between basic readiness and meaningful digital financial participation.



(a) Connectivity depth: 3M vs. 7D.

(b) Digital vs. foundational ID coverage.

(c) Active digital ID verification rate.

Figure 15: Page 2 readiness evidence used in the storytelling analysis.

9.2.3 Page 3: Identifying Account Access and Exclusion

Page 3 is the central diagnostic layer of the dashboard. It moves from digital readiness to direct financial access. The KPI cards report Banking Inclusion at 74.93%, Financial Institution Account at 74.05%, Mobile Money Account at 46.69%, and Digital Account at 67.03%. The 27.36 percentage-point gap between financial institution accounts and mobile money accounts suggests that traditional accounts remain more widespread than mobile money.

The page also turns access into an exclusion diagnosis. Its filters allow users to segment the story by Urbanicity, Gender, Workforce Status, Education Level, and Income Group. Meanwhile, the Exclusion Friction Log identifies barriers such as not enough money, distance, fees, lack of trust, and lack of documentation. As a result, Page 3 does not only ask how many people are included; it also asks who remains excluded and why.

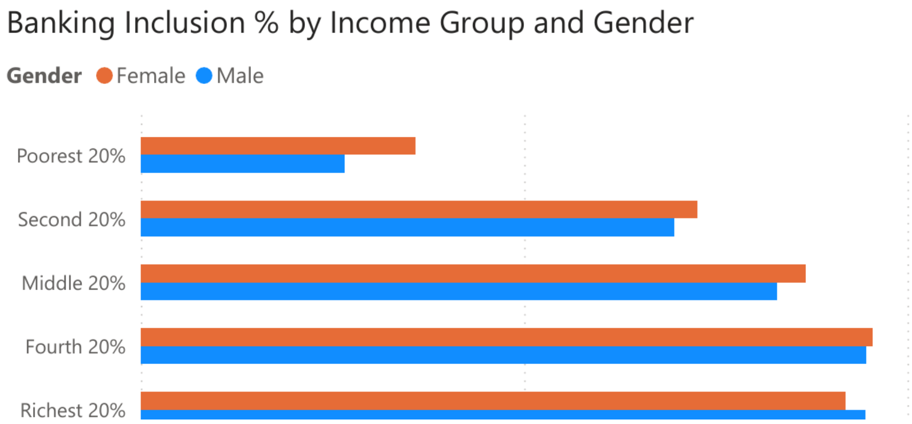


Figure 16: Banking inclusion by income group and gender.

See also Figures 7, 8, 4, and 11.

9.2.4 Page 4: Moving from Access to Cash-Flow Usage

Page 4 prevents the story from stopping at account ownership. It asks whether financial flows are actually delivered through digital channels or still depend on cash. Corporate/Formal Wages are largely digital, with 80.99% delivered directly to an account and 18.60% cash-only. In contrast, Agricultural Sales remain cash-dependent, with 73.42% cash-only and only 25.79% delivered digitally to an account.

The page also reveals a geographic usage gap. Urban Merchant Payments reach 65.79%, compared with 50.30% in rural areas; Urban In-Store Digital Pay reaches 62.67%, compared with 46.11% in rural areas. These comparisons show that financial inclusion must be evaluated through actual transaction behavior, not only through account ownership.

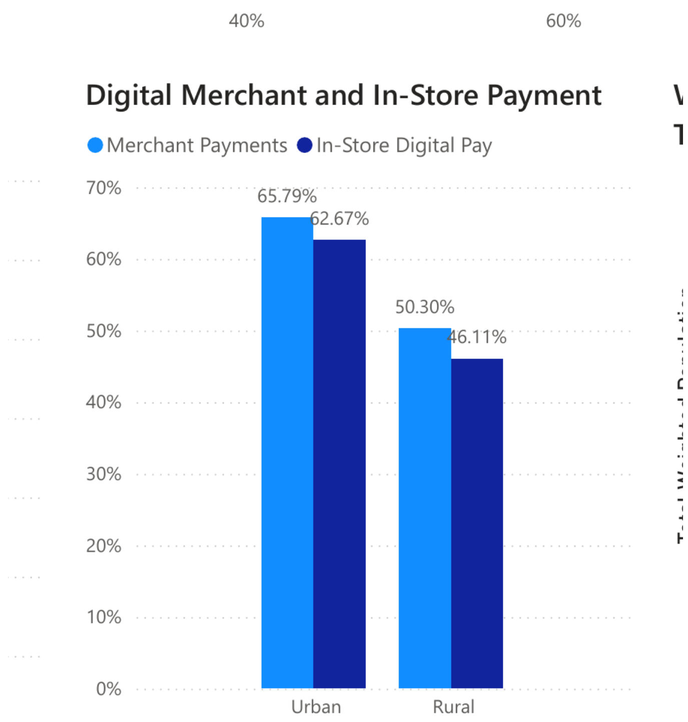


Figure 17: Digital merchant and in-store payment by geography.

See Figure 5.

9.2.5 Page 5: Evaluating Financial Health and Resilience

The final page connects financial participation to financial health and resilience. The KPI cards show that 73.05% of respondents saved, while 45.98% borrowed. This shifts the dashboard from access and usage toward financial outcomes.

The resilience tables provide the strongest evidence for this final stage. For the Poorest 20% group, Family & Friends is 86 while Formal Savings is only 30. For the Richest 20% group, Formal Savings is 60 while Family & Friends is 34. This contrast suggests that poorer groups depend more heavily on informal support, while richer groups are more connected to formal savings channels.

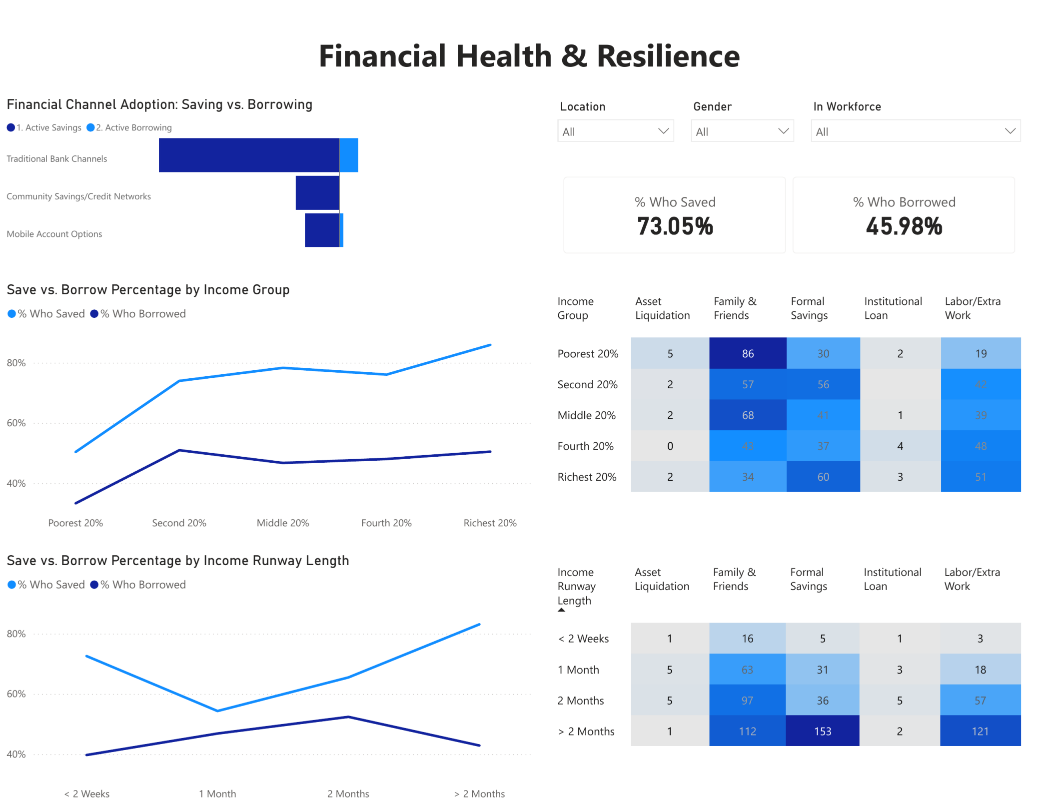
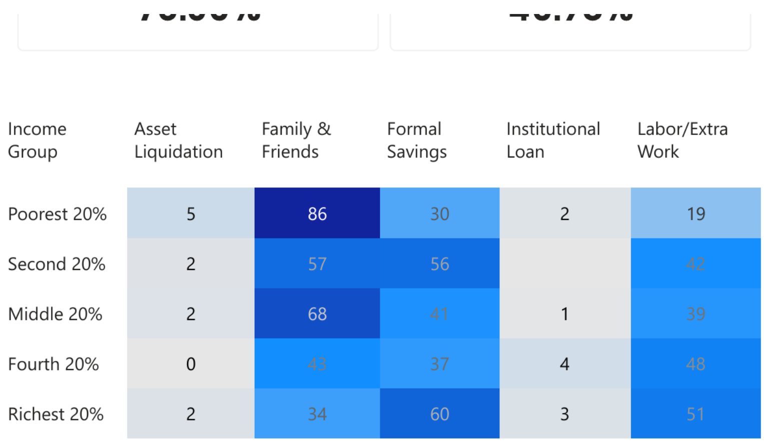


Figure 18: Financial Health & Resilience page overview.



Income Group	Asset Liquidation	Family & Friends	Formal Savings	Institutional Loan	Labor/Extra Work
Poorest 20%	5	86	30	2	19
Second 20%	2	57	56		42
Middle 20%	2	68	41	1	39
Fourth 20%	0	43	37	4	48
Richest 20%	2	34	60	3	51

Figure 19: Coping channels by income group.

9.3 Bridge to the Storytelling Analysis

Together, the five pages form a clear policy narrative. Page 1 establishes the population context, Page 2 tests digital readiness, Page 3 diagnoses account access and exclusion, Page 4 examines cash-flow usage, and Page 5 evaluates financial health and resilience.

This order prevents financial inclusion from being reduced to a single account ownership metric.

The remainder of this chapter analyzes the dashboard through four storytelling dimensions:

1. **Story structure**: how the dashboard organizes the narrative from context to resilience.
2. **Storytelling principles**: how overview-first design, segmentation, comparison, gap analysis, and diagnostic framing support the story.
3. **Narrative style**: how the dashboard uses a neutral, institutional, evidence-based policy tone.
4. **Interaction and exploration**: how filters and subgroup views allow users to move from national indicators to targeted policy questions.

See Figure 14.

9.4 Story Structure

The dashboard follows a clear story structure rather than presenting financial inclusion as a single isolated statistic. Its narrative can be summarized as a five-stage policy journey:

Context → Readiness → Access → Usage → Resilience

This structure is both *macro-to-micro* and *input-to-outcome*. It is macro-to-micro because the dashboard begins with the socioeconomic composition of the population before moving into more specific financial indicators. It is input-to-outcome because the story starts with enabling conditions, such as digital readiness and account access, and ends with financial health and resilience. This order prevents the analysis from treating account ownership as the final meaning of financial inclusion.

See Figure 14.

9.4.1 Narrative Spine

The narrative spine of the dashboard is organized around a sequence of policy questions. Page 1 asks who is being analyzed. Page 2 asks whether that population is digitally prepared. Page 3 asks who owns accounts and who remains excluded. Page 4 asks whether financial flows are actually digital. Page 5 asks whether financial participation is connected to financial resilience. Table 2 summarizes this sequence.
This sequence is illustrated across Figures 1, 15, 7, 5, and 18.

Story stage	**Dashboard page**	**Guiding question**	**Main evidence**
Context	Page 1	Who is being analyzed?	Urban Concentration Rate = 30.33%; In Workforce Rate = 87.92%
Readiness	Page 2	Are people digitally prepared?	Internet Use 3M = 87.85%; Active Digital ID Verification = 32.68%
Access	Page 3	Who owns accounts and who is excluded?	Banking Inclusion = 74.93%; Mobile Money Account = 46.69%
Usage	Page 4	Are financial flows actually digital?	Formal wages digital = 80.99%; Agricultural Sales cash-only = 73.42%
Resilience	Page 5	Does inclusion support financial health?	Who Saved = 73.05%; Who Borrowed = 45.98%

Table 2: Narrative spine of the Vietnam Financial Inclusion Dashboard.

9.4.2 Transition Logic

The strength of this story structure lies in the transitions between stages. Each page answers one question and creates the need for the next question. After Page 1 establishes the socioeconomic baseline, Page 2 checks whether the population has the digital foundation required for digital financial inclusion. Page 3 then moves from digital readiness to actual account access and exclusion. Page 4 challenges the access result by asking whether money flows through digital channels in practice. Finally, Page 5 shifts the story from participation to financial outcomes by examining saving, borrowing, and resilience.

This transition logic is important because it complicates a simple success narrative. Page 3 shows relatively high account inclusion, with Banking Inclusion at 74.93% and Financial Institution Account at 74.05%. However, Page 4 shows that some financial flows remain strongly cash-based, especially Agricultural Sales, where 73.42% are cash-only. Page 5 then adds an outcome dimension by showing that resilience differs by income group: the Poorest 20% rely more on Family & Friends, while the Richest 20% show stronger use of Formal Savings.

As a result, the dashboard presents financial inclusion as a multi-stage policy issue. Inclusion is not only about having an account; it also depends on digital activation, transaction usage, and the ability to manage financial shocks. The story structure therefore turns the dashboard from a static statistical report into a guided policy diagnosis.

See Figures 7, 5, and 19.

9.5 Storytelling Principles

After defining the dashboard's story structure, this subsection explains the main storytelling principles that make the visual sequence readable and policy-oriented. Instead of describing every chart separately, the analysis focuses on how the dashboard uses overview-first design, progressive disclosure, segmentation, comparison, gap analysis, diagnostic framing, and outcome-oriented storytelling to turn weighted survey indicators into a coherent financial inclusion narrative.

9.5.1 Overview First and Progressive Disclosure

The dashboard first gives users high-level anchors before moving into detailed subgroup evidence. This follows the overview-first principle: national KPI cards establish the baseline, while later charts provide breakdowns and explanations. For example, Page 1 introduces the population context with Urban Concentration Rate at 30.33%, Secondary Education Threshold Rate at 89.98%, and In Workforce Rate at 87.92%. Page 3 applies the same logic to account access, with Banking Inclusion at 74.93%, Financial Institution Account at 74.05%, Mobile Money Account at 46.69%, and Digital Account at 67.03%. Page 5 then gives outcome-level anchors: 73.05% saved and 45.98% borrowed.

The dashboard also uses progressive disclosure. It does not show financial inclusion as one final number. Instead, it reveals the story in layers:

Context → Readiness → Access → Usage → Resilience

This sequence prevents premature conclusions. For instance, Page 2 shows strong basic readiness, with Internet Use in the last three months at 87.85% and Foundational ID coverage at 99.65%. However, Active Digital ID Verification is only 32.68%, showing that digital access does not automatically become active digital participation. Similarly, the account-access indicators on Page 3 are later tested against cash-flow behavior on Page 4. *See Figures 1, 15, 7, 5, and 18.*

9.5.2 Segmentation and Comparison

The dashboard avoids relying only on national averages by repeatedly segmenting the evidence by income group, education, gender, location, and workforce status. This is important because financial inclusion is a distributional issue. Page 1 shows this clearly through the Socioeconomic Matrix. In the Poorest 20% group, only 6 respondents have tertiary education or more, compared with 72 in the Richest 20% group. This contrast prepares the reader to interpret later financial gaps as part of a broader socioeconomic pattern.

Comparison is also used to make gaps visible. On Page 3, Financial Institution Account ownership is 74.05%, while Mobile Money Account ownership is 46.69%, a gap of 27.36

percentage points. On Page 4, Urban Merchant Payments reach 65.79%, compared with 50.30% in rural areas. Urban In-Store Digital Pay is 62.67%, compared with 46.11% in rural areas. These comparisons turn individual values into interpretable policy differences. *See Figures 2, 7, and 17.*

9.5.3 Gap Analysis and Diagnostic Framing

Gap analysis is one of the dashboard's strongest storytelling principles. It helps distinguish basic access from meaningful activation. Page 2 shows that Foundational ID coverage is 99.65%, Online Digital ID is 71.19%, and Active Digital ID Verification is only 32.68%. The gap between Online Digital ID and Active Digital ID Verification is therefore 38.51 percentage points. This creates a clear access-versus-activation story.

The same diagnostic logic appears on Page 3 through the Exclusion Friction Log. Instead of only reporting who is unbanked, the dashboard decomposes exclusion into possible barriers such as Family Member Has One, Not Enough Money, Too Far Away, Too Expensive, Lack of Trust, and Lack of Documentation. Because the PDF export does not show exact labels for every barrier, this report treats the visual as a diagnostic framework rather than assigning exact percentages to each barrier.
See Figures 15b, 15c, and 11.

9.5.4 Access-to-Usage and Outcome-Oriented Storytelling

The dashboard does not equate account ownership with complete financial inclusion. Page 3 shows relatively high access, with Banking Inclusion at 74.93% and Digital Account ownership at 67.03%. However, Page 4 asks whether financial flows are actually digital. The contrast is important: Corporate/Formal Wages are 80.99% digital direct-to-account, while Agricultural Sales are 73.42% cash-only. Government Subsidies/Transfers also remain more cash-oriented, with 56.96% cash-only.

The final page makes the story outcome-oriented. Page 5 moves from access and usage to financial health and resilience. It reports that 73.05% of respondents saved, while 45.98% borrowed. The coping table then shows that the Poorest 20% group relies more on Family & Friends at 86 than on Formal Savings at 30. In contrast, the Richest 20% group records Formal Savings at 60 and Family & Friends at 34. This ending shows that financial inclusion should be evaluated not only by access, but also by resilience outcomes. *See Figures 7, 5, and 19.*

9.5.5 Summary of Storytelling Principles

Table 3 summarizes the principles used by the dashboard and the evidence supporting each one.

Principle	Dashboard evidence	Storytelling function
Overview first	KPI cards on Pages 1, 3, and 5	Provides national baselines before detailed analysis
Progressive disclosure	Context → Readiness → Access → Usage → Resilience	Reveals financial inclusion as a multi-stage journey
Segmentation and comparison	Income–education matrix; account ownership gap; urban–rural payment gap	Makes inequality and group differences visible
Gap analysis and diagnosis	Active Digital ID Verification = 32.68%; Exclusion Friction Log	Distinguishes access from activation and identifies barriers
Access-to-usage reasoning	Banking Inclusion = 74.93%; Agricultural Sales cash-only = 73.42%	Shows that account ownership does not guarantee digital usage
Outcome orientation	Saved = 73.05%; Borrowed = 45.98%; coping table by income group	Connects inclusion to financial health and resilience

Table 3: Summary of storytelling principles and supporting dashboard evidence.

Overall, these storytelling principles turn the dashboard from a descriptive set of charts into a structured analytical narrative. The user first receives a national overview, then moves through segmentation, comparison, gap diagnosis, usage analysis, and resilience outcomes. This makes the dashboard suitable for policy interpretation rather than simple statistical reporting.

9.6 Narrative Style

The narrative style of the Vietnam Financial Inclusion Dashboard 2025 is **institutional, evidence-based, and policy-diagnostic**. The dashboard does not use emotional appeals or individual anecdotes. Instead, it builds its argument through measured indicators, structured comparisons, subgroup breakdowns, and diagnostic gaps. This style is appropriate for a dashboard based on weighted Global Findex microdata because its purpose is to support policy interpretation rather than promotion or entertainment.

The overall tone can be summarized as:

Neutral evidence → Diagnostic comparison → Policy interpretation

In this sense, the dashboard acts like an analytical policy brief. It does not only report whether financial inclusion exists; it shows where inclusion is strong, where it weakens, and which population groups or payment flows require closer attention.
See Figures 1, 15, 7, 5, and 18.

9.6.1 Evidence-Based and Diagnostic Tone

The dashboard lets quantitative gaps carry the argument. On Page 2, Online Digital ID reaches 71.19%, while Active Digital ID Verification is only 32.68%. This 38.51 percentage-point gap supports the interpretation that digital access does not automatically become active digital use. The Digital Activity Profile reinforces the same neutral tone: Social Media activity reaches 94.46%, while Gov activity is 15.63% and Job activity is only 4.89%. The visual language remains factual, allowing the reader to infer the problem from measurable contrasts.

The dashboard is also diagnostic because it does not stop at national-level outcomes. Page 3 reports Banking Inclusion at 74.93%, Financial Institution Account ownership at 74.05%, Digital Account ownership at 67.03%, and Mobile Money Account ownership at 46.69%. However, the Exclusion Friction Log then breaks remaining exclusion into barriers such as Not Enough Money, Too Far Away, Too Expensive, Lack of Trust, and Lack of Documentation. This changes the narrative from a descriptive statement about account access into a diagnostic question about why exclusion persists.

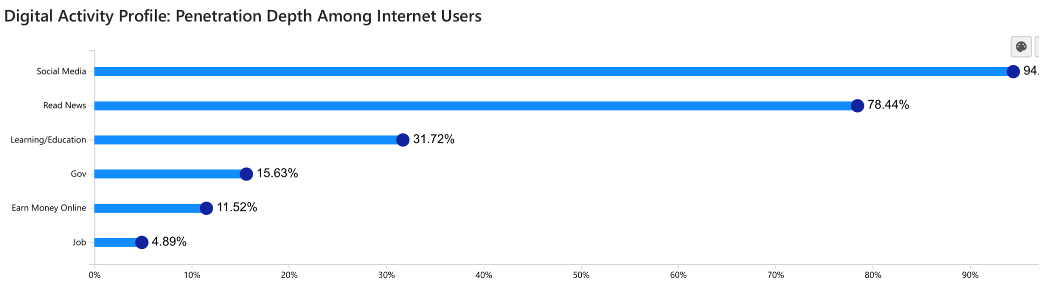


Figure 20: Digital activity profile: penetration depth among internet users.

See also Figures 15c, 7, and 11.

9.6.2 Comparative Policy Narrative

A major feature of the dashboard's narrative style is comparison. Page 4 shows that Corporate/Formal Wages are mostly digitized, with 80.99% delivered directly to an account and 18.60% cash-only. Agricultural Sales show the opposite pattern: 73.42% are cash-only, while only 25.79% are delivered digitally to an account. Government Subsidies/Transfers are also more cash-oriented, with 56.96% cash-only and 35.35% digital direct-to-account.

The same comparative style appears in the urban–rural payment gap. Urban Merchant Payments reach 65.79%, compared with 50.30% in rural areas. Urban In-Store Digital Pay reaches 62.67%, compared with 46.11% in rural areas. These paired comparisons turn the dashboard from a generic report about digital payments into a policy narrative about uneven digitization across sectors and geographies.
See Figures 5 and 17.

9.6.3 Policy-Oriented and Outcome-Oriented Ending

The dashboard's narrative style is policy-oriented because each major gap points toward an area for further investigation. The identity gap suggests a need to look beyond ID availability toward user activation. The mobile money gap suggests that account access differs by channel. The cash dependence of Agricultural Sales suggests that digitization is weaker in some payment flows than in formal wage channels. The rural payment gap suggests uneven merchant acceptance and payment infrastructure.

The final page gives the story an outcome-oriented endpoint. Page 5 reports that 73.05% of respondents saved, while 45.98% borrowed. More importantly, the coping-channel table shows that the Poorest 20% rely on Family & Friends at 86, while Formal Savings is only 30. In contrast, the Richest 20% show Formal Savings at 60 and Family & Friends at 34. This ending prevents the dashboard from treating financial inclusion as an end in itself. The final question is whether people have the capacity to save, borrow safely, and respond to financial shocks.
See Figures 18 and 19.

9.6.4 Summary of Narrative Style

Table 4 summarizes how the dashboard's narrative style is supported by selected visual evidence.

Table 4: Summary of narrative style and supporting evidence

Narrative quality	**Supporting evidence from the dashboard**
Institutional	Formal policy-dashboard language and weighted Global Findex indicators across the five dashboard pages.
Evidence-based	Online Digital ID = 71.19%; Active Digital ID Verification = 32.68%.
Diagnostic	The Exclusion Friction Log decomposes unbanked barriers on the Account Ownership page.
Comparative	Financial Institution Account = 74.05% versus Mobile Money Account = 46.69%; Urban Merchant Payments = 65.79% versus Rural Merchant Payments = 50.30%.
Policy-oriented	Agricultural Sales cash-only = 73.42%; rural payment gaps and mobile money gaps point to areas for further policy investigation.
Outcome-oriented	% Who Saved = 73.05%, % Who Borrowed = 45.98%, followed by income-based coping-channel differences.

Overall, the dashboard uses a neutral and evidence-based narrative style to identify structural barriers in Vietnam's financial inclusion landscape. This style prepares the reader for the next analytical dimension: how interaction and exploration allow users to move from national indicators into subgroup-level policy investigation.

9.7 Interaction and Exploration in the Story

The Vietnam Financial Inclusion Dashboard 2025 is not only a fixed visual report. It also functions as an **exploratory policy workspace** that lets users move from national indicators to subgroup-level questions. This matters because financial inclusion can vary by location, gender, income, education, and workforce status. The dashboard therefore supports a movement from broad summary evidence to more targeted policy investigation.

The interaction logic can be summarized as follows:

National overview → subgroup filtering → comparison → diagnostic interpretation

The clearest interactive elements appear on Page 3, *The Account Ownership & Access Landscape*, and Page 5, *Financial Health & Resilience*. Page 3 provides slicers for *Urbanicity*, *Income Group*, *Gender*, *Education Level*, and *In Workforce*. Page 5 provides slicers for *Location*, *Gender*, and *In Workforce*. In the exported PDF, these filters appear in the default *All* state, so the report can confirm their presence and placement even though live filtered states cannot be tested from the static file.
See Figures 8 and 18.

9.7.1 From Overview to Subgroup Exploration

A central interaction principle is the movement from national overview to filtered exploration. Page 3 first gives users a national account-access baseline: Banking Inclusion is 74.93%, Financial Institution Account ownership is 74.05%, Mobile Money Account ownership is 46.69%, and Digital Account ownership is 67.03%. The slicers placed near these KPI cards then allow the same account-access story to be examined through different population lenses.

This design is important because a national average can hide structural gaps. A headline Banking Inclusion rate of 74.93% is useful as an overview, but it does not show which groups may be less included. The filters therefore extend the dashboard story from a single national statement into a set of subgroup questions: Which groups are included, which groups remain excluded, and whether the barriers differ across social categories.
See Figures 7 and 8.

9.7.2 Exploration Through Comparison and Hypothesis Testing

The dashboard also supports exploration by structuring many visuals as comparisons. Page 3 compares account channels: Financial Institution Account ownership is 74.05%, while Mobile Money Account ownership is 46.69%. This 27.36-percentage-point gap suggests that traditional financial institution accounts remain more widespread than mobile money.

Page 4 extends comparison to usage behavior. Urban Merchant Payments reach 65.79%, compared with 50.30% in rural areas. Urban In-Store Digital Pay reaches 62.67%, compared with 46.11% in rural areas. The same page also compares financial inflow channels: Corporate/Formal Wages are mostly digital, with 80.99% delivered directly to an account, while Agricultural Sales remain heavily cash-based, with 73.42% cash-only.

These comparisons allow users to test policy hypotheses. For example, Page 2 supports the hypothesis that digital access is high but activation is weaker: Internet Use in the last three months is 87.85%, Foundational ID coverage is 99.65%, but Active Digital ID Verification is only 32.68%. Page 4 supports the hypothesis that account ownership does not automatically become digital cash-flow usage. Page 5 supports the hypothesis that resilience differs by income group: the Poorest 20% rely on Family & Friends at 86 and Formal Savings at 30, while the Richest 20% show Formal Savings at 60 and Family & Friends at 34.

Table 5: Examples of exploratory questions supported by the dashboard

Exploratory question	**Dashboard evidence**	**Interpretation**
Does access become activation?	Online Digital ID 71.19%; Active Digital ID Verification 32.68%.	Digital access is not fully converted into active use.
Does account ownership become digital usage?	Banking Inclusion 74.93%; Agricultural Sales cash-only 73.42%.	Account access and cash-flow digitization must be evaluated separately.
Does resilience differ by income group?	Poorest 20%: Family & Friends 86, Formal Savings 30; Richest 20%: Formal Savings 60, Family & Friends 34.	Poorer groups rely more on informal support.

See Figures 15, 7, 5, 17, and 19.

9.7.3 Limits of the Static Export

Because the available dashboard is a static PDF export, the interaction analysis should avoid overstating what can be directly tested. The PDF confirms that slicers exist, where they are placed, and that the default state is generally *All*. It also confirms that the visual design supports comparison across groups, channels, and payment methods.

However, the PDF does not allow the analyst to click filters, inspect hover tooltips, or observe the exact recalculation of KPI cards and charts after each selection. Therefore, the report should describe the dashboard as *designed for* subgroup exploration rather than claiming exact filtered-state values that are not visible in the exported file.
See Figures 13 and 18.

9.7.4 Summary of Interaction and Exploration

Interaction plays three main roles in the dashboard story. First, it enables **personalization of insight** by allowing users to focus on relevant population groups. Second, it supports **comparison across segments**, such as urban versus rural users, financial institution accounts versus mobile money, and cash versus digital delivery. Third, it supports **hypothesis testing** by helping users examine whether access becomes activation, whether account ownership becomes usage, and whether inclusion connects to resilience.

Table 6: Summary of interaction roles in the dashboard story

Interaction role	**Dashboard evidence**	**Storytelling contribution**
Personalization of insight	Page 3 filters: Urbanicity, Income Group, Gender, Education Level, In Workforce; Page 5 filters: Location, Gender, In Workforce.	Users can move beyond national averages.
Comparison across segments	Financial Institution Account 74.05% versus Mobile Money Account 46.69%; Urban Merchant Payments 65.79% versus Rural Merchant Payments 50.30%.	Users can identify where gaps are located.
Hypothesis testing	Active Digital ID Verification 32.68%; Agricultural Sales cash-only 73.42%; Poorest 20% Family & Friends 86 versus Formal Savings 30.	Users can test whether access becomes activation, usage, and resilience.

Overall, interaction and exploration make the dashboard more than a fixed visual summary. Its filters and comparative visuals allow users to move between national evidence and subgroup-level policy questions. This strengthens the dashboard's role as an evidence-based policy workspace for diagnosing financial inclusion, digital usage, cash dependency, and resilience in Vietnam.